

Wyoming Voters Should Choose

Public source packet for Skovgard2026.org

Public message: Wyoming voters should choose. Party insiders should serve.

Share page: <https://skovgard2026.org/share/wyoming-voters-choose/>

Prepared: May 23, 2026

Freedom means voters choose. Control means insiders choose first and voters are expected to fall in line. The people choose. The party serves. The government answers to us.

Purpose of this Source Packet

This public source packet supports the message titled **Wyoming Voters Should Choose**. The message argues for voter power, local control, and primary elections decided by voters before party money or party machinery favors one candidate over another in a contested primary.

The packet cites public reporting, official state law sources, an official party convention page, and local commentary. At the time this packet was prepared, a final adopted 2026 Wyoming GOP bylaws PDF confirming the exact final text had not been located. For that reason, the bylaw text is described as **reported bylaw language** unless sourced to a final official document.

Source Summary

- WyoFile is the main public reporting source for the adopted bylaw framework. WyoFile reported that the Wyoming GOP adopted bylaws establishing a framework to vet, endorse, and financially back candidates before the primary.
- Cowboy State Daily is a public source for the proposed bylaw language before the convention, including language about endorsing, supporting, opposing, and providing financial assistance to candidates at any point in the election cycle.
- The Wyoming Secretary of State and Wyoming Legislature provide official sources for Wyoming election law, including W.S. 22-25-104.
- The Wyoming GOP 2026 State Convention page confirms convention dates, location, and agenda context, including the Report of the Bylaws Committee.
- Community Chatter / Shurie Scheel provides local Hot Springs County commentary and the bylaw language as quoted in the article text reviewed for this packet.

Core Issue

The share page argues that a primary election should belong to the voters. Party leaders, county committees, candidates, and advocacy groups can speak and organize, but the key public concern is whether party money and party machinery should favor one candidate over another before primary voters decide.

Reported Bylaw Language at Issue

The Community Chatter opinion text attributes the following language to a bylaw change presented by Weston County:

"The Wyoming Republican Party, through its State and County Central Committees, reserves the absolute First Amendment right to endorse, support, oppose, and provide financial assistance to candidates of its choosing at any point in the election cycle, including prior to a primary election. The Party's decisions regarding the use of its private funds and the content of its political speech are core associational activities. Any state law or administrative rule purporting to limit, restrict or prohibit this private advocacy is hereby declared unconstitutional and void."

Cowboy State Daily reported similar proposed language before the convention. WyoFile later reported that the party adopted bylaws establishing a pre-primary vetting, endorsement, and financial-backing framework.

Wyoming Law at Issue

The relevant Wyoming statute is W.S. 22-25-104, titled **Restriction on party funds in primary elections**. The Wyoming Secretary of State Election Code PDF and Wyoming Legislature Title 22 PDF both provide the statute text.

"No political party funds shall be expended directly or indirectly in the aid of the nomination of any one person as against another person of the same political party running in the primary election."

Public Timeline and Context

- April 23 to April 25, 2026: The Wyoming GOP held its 2026 State Convention at the Wyoming State Fairgrounds in Douglas. The official convention page lists the convention agenda and includes the Report of the Bylaws Committee.
- April 23, 2026: Cowboy State Daily reported that county party proposals sought major bylaw changes, including language about party authority to endorse, support, oppose, and financially assist candidates at any point in the election cycle.
- April 27 and April 28, 2026: WyoFile reported that the party adopted bylaws creating a framework to vet, endorse, and financially back candidates before the primary election.
- May 20, 2026: Community Chatter published an opinion by Shurie Scheel describing the Hot Springs County dispute, the bylaw language, and the concern that primary voters should decide before party leaders use party support to favor candidates.

Key public question: Should party machinery favor a candidate before primary voters decide, or should the party wait for voters to choose the nominee?

Source Details

S1. Wyoming GOP 2026 State Convention page

Source type: Official party page

Link: <https://www.wyoming.gop/wygop-2026-state-convention>

Relevance: Confirms convention context: the 2026 Wyoming GOP State Convention occurred April 23 to April 25, 2026, at the Wyoming State Fairgrounds in Douglas. The agenda includes the Report of the Bylaws Committee.

Public note: Use this source for convention timing, location, agenda, and party contact context. This page, standing alone, does not provide the final adopted bylaw PDF.

S2. WyoFile: Wyoming Republican Party plans to buck law and endorse candidates ahead of critical primary

Source type: Independent Wyoming news report

Link: <https://wyofile.com/wyoming-republican-party-plans-to-buck-law-and-endorse-candidates-ahead-of-critical-primary/>

Relevance: Main public reporting source for the adopted bylaw framework. WyoFile reported that the party adopted bylaws creating a framework to vet, endorse, and financially back candidates before the primary.

Public note: Use this as the strongest public source for the adopted action and the pre-primary endorsement framework.

S3. Cowboy State Daily: Wyoming GOP Considering Loyalty Tests For Candidates, Voiding State Laws

Source type: Independent Wyoming news report

Link: <https://cowboystatedaily.com/2026/04/22/wyoming-gop-considering-loyalty-tests-for-candidates-voiding-state-laws/>

Relevance: Public source for the reported proposed bylaw language before the convention. The article describes proposed changes and quotes language about endorsing, supporting, opposing, and financially assisting candidates at any point in the election cycle.

Public note: Use this source for the reported proposed bylaw language and the conflict with Wyoming election law.

S4. Wyoming Secretary of State: Election Code PDF

Source type: Official state election-law source

Link: https://sos.wyo.gov/forms/Publications/ElectionCode_8.5x11.pdf

Relevance: Official election-law source for W.S. 22-25-104, the statute restricting party funds in primary elections.

Public note: Use this as a primary legal source because it comes from the Wyoming Secretary of State.

S5. Wyoming Legislature: Title 22 PDF

Source type: Official state statutes source

Link: <https://wyoleg.gov/statutes/compress/title22.pdf>

Relevance: Legislature-hosted source for Title 22, including W.S. 22-25-104.

Public note: Use this as a second official legal source or backup for the Secretary of State Election Code PDF.

S6. Justia: WY Stat Section 22-25-104

Source type: Readable statute mirror

Link: <https://law.justia.com/codes/wyoming/title-22/chapter-25/section-22-25-104/>

Relevance: Plain web version of W.S. 22-25-104, useful for readers who want a simple webpage instead of a PDF.

Public note: Use as a convenience source alongside official Wyoming state sources.

S7. Community Chatter / Shurie Scheel opinion: Here's the Truth Behind the Take Back Wyoming Shop Party

Source type: Local commentary

Link: <https://skovgard2026.org/share/wyoming-voters-choose/>

Relevance: Provides local Hot Springs County context, bylaw language quoted in the article text reviewed for this packet, and the voter-power argument that primary voters should choose before party support is used to favor candidates.

Public note: A separate public URL for this commentary was not available at the time this packet was prepared. This source is included for local context and should be read alongside the public reporting and official law sources above.

S8. WYGOP 2024 Bylaws page

Source type: Official party governing-docs background

Link: <https://www.wyoming.gop/post/wygop-2024-bylaws>

Relevance: Shows that Wyoming GOP bylaws and governing documents have been published online in prior convention cycles.

Public note: Use only as background context and as a monitoring location for any later 2026 bylaw upload.

S9. Eu v. San Francisco County Democratic Central Committee, 489 U.S. 214 (1989)

Source type: U.S. Supreme Court background

Link: <https://supreme.justia.com/cases/federal/us/489/214/>

Relevance: Provides legal background frequently raised in disputes about party endorsement bans and political party associational rights.

Public note: Use only as background legal context. This packet does not provide legal advice.

Claim-to-Source Map

Public claim	Best source	Use note
The Wyoming GOP held its 2026 State Convention April 23 to April 25, 2026, in Douglas, and the agenda included the Report of the Bylaws Committee.	Wyoming GOP 2026 State Convention page	Official convention context.
The party adopted bylaws establishing a framework to vet, endorse, and financially back candidates before the primary.	WyoFile	Main public reporting source for adopted action.
Reported bylaw language claims authority to endorse, support, oppose, and financially assist candidates at any point in the election cycle.	Cowboy State Daily; Community Chatter / Shurie Scheel	Use as reported language unless the final adopted bylaw PDF is added later.
Wyoming law restricts party funds from aiding one same-party candidate over another in a primary.	Wyoming Secretary of State Election Code PDF; Wyoming Legislature Title 22 PDF; Justia mirror	Use official sources first. Justia is a readable backup.

Public claim	Best source	Use note
The public concern is that primary voters should decide before party money or party machinery favors one candidate.	W.S. 22-25-104; WyoFile; Community Chatter / Shurie Scheel	Fair public synthesis of the legal dispute and local concern.

Public Source Links

Wyoming GOP 2026 State Convention page

<https://www.wyoming.gop/wygop-2026-state-convention>

WyoFile article

<https://wyofile.com/wyoming-republican-party-plans-to-buck-law-and-endorse-candidates-ahead-of-critical-primary/>

Cowboy State Daily article

<https://cowboystatedaily.com/2026/04/22/wyoming-gop-considering-loyalty-tests-for-candidates-voiding-state-laws/>

Wyoming Secretary of State Election Code PDF

https://sos.wyo.gov/forms/Publications/ElectionCode_8.5x11.pdf

Wyoming Legislature Title 22 PDF

<https://wyoleg.gov/statutes/compress/title22.pdf>

Justia W.S. 22-25-104 page

<https://law.justia.com/codes/wyoming/title-22/chapter-25/section-22-25-104/>

WYGOP 2024 Bylaws page

<https://www.wyoming.gop/post/wygop-2024-bylaws>

Eu v. San Francisco County Democratic Central Committee

<https://supreme.justia.com/cases/federal/us/489/214/>

Closing principle: The people choose. The party serves. The government answers to us.

Join the movement at Skovgard2026.org.